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day nano-sized silicon tips, capable of chiseling out a relief map of the world from a substrate of organic molecular glass.

e will start from pre-modern examples of nanotechnology of medieval glass workers to the present

Pre-modern Examples of Nanotechnology (pre-1800s)

Roman Period (30BC – 640AD)

Anyone who thinks that nanotechnology is a modern phenomenon will find contradicted by archaeological evidences. The word may not have existed, but it was certainly being put to use by the Romans. The Lycurgus Cup which now resides in the British Museum in London is an example of dichroic glass. Transmission Electron Microscopy reveals that this glass contains nanoparticles of colloidal gold and silver, which turns this opaque green cup into a glowing translucent red when light shines through the inside. Although it is highly likely that the unique properties of this ancient Roman piece were created by accident,

it is still the earliest surviving example of the use of Nanotechnology materials.



The Lycurgus Cup
Without light.

The Lycurgus Cup In light.

Medieval Period (500AD – 1450AD)

Just like their earlier Roman counterparts, Medieval Glass artists were the accidental users of nanotech-